

FIELD GUIDE FG-001

A LETTER TO MY FUTURE SELF

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Date: January 13, 2026

To: Future Me

From: Present Me

Dear Future Me,

I'm writing this from the past. Well, your past. My present. Time is confusing when you're a developer.

I want you to know that I'm trying. I'm trying to write good code. I'm trying to write tests. I'm trying to document things. But sometimes, I fail.

Sometimes I write a function that's too long. Sometimes I skip the tests "just this once." Sometimes I write a comment that says "TODO: Fix this later" and then never do.

I want you to know that I'm sorry. Sorry for the technical debt. Sorry for the shortcuts. Sorry for the "it works on my machine" moments.

But I also want you to know that I'm learning. Every bug teaches me something. Every code review makes me better. Every refactoring session shows me a better way.

So when you're debugging my code at 2 AM, remember: I was doing my best. And when you're cursing my name because of that one function that makes no sense, remember: I probably had a reason. It might not have been a good reason, but it was a reason.

And most importantly: when you're writing code that future you will have to maintain, remember this letter. Remember that you were once me, and I was once someone else's future self.

Write good code. Write tests. Write documentation. Your future self will thank you.

Love,
Present Me

P.S. - If you're reading this and the codebase is still a mess, I'm really sorry. I tried.

P.P.S. - If you're reading this and the codebase is beautiful and well-maintained, you're welcome. You're welcome.